



SOLDIERS MARCHED 20 MILES (30 KM) A DAY. BOOTS WITH HARD-WEARING IRON STUDS ON THE SOLES WERE ESSENTIAL.

Centuries were themselves broken down into the smallest units of all—squads of eight soldiers who would share a tent together while they were on campaign. Each century was led by a centurion. Above him were six officers, called tribunes, who advised the legion's commanding officer, the legate.

WEIRD WORLD

ON THE MARCH, LEGIONARIES CARRIED EQUIPMENT—WEIGHING BETWEEN 60 AND 90 LB (27 AND 40 KG)—ON THEIR SHOULDERS. THEY WERE NICKNAMED "MARIUS'S MULES," AFTER THE GENERAL WHO HAD IMPROVED THE ROMAN ARMY.

Weapons and armor

During the 2nd century CE, when the army reached its greatest size of 380,000 men, legionaries were issued fairly standard equipment. Weapons included a dagger (*pugio*), a short sword (*gladius*), and a heavy javelin (*pilum*), the tip of which would bend on impact, making it impossible to be thrown back by the enemy.

Legionaries wore strips of flexible metal and

THE SHORT SWORD WAS THE LEGIONARY'S MAIN WEAPON FOR CLOSE-RANGE FIGHTING. THIS ONE IS IN ITS SCABBARD. THE JAVELIN WAS THROWN FROM A DISTANCE.

leather armor on their bodies. Metal helmets protected the soldiers' heads, cheeks, and necks. Large rectangular shields deflected enemy missiles, and they could also be overlapped to form all-around protection for a group of men. On the march, the legionary carried not

